

Task Overview

Each contributor should create new accounts on Instagram Reels, TikTok, and Facebook Reels to evaluate how well the platforms recommend relevant content in different scenarios

Tooling

Smartphone - Contributors will conduct the exercise on their smartphone (Android or iPhone) while screen-recording the session for subsequent ADAP data entry. iPad is not recommended as it is unable to play Facebook Reels.

Apps – Contributors will create new accounts and conduct the exercise on three different apps - Facebook (Facebook Reels; not videos), Instagram (Instagram Reels), and TikTok (For You).

ADAP Tooling – Contributors will enter video data utilizing their screen recording for each ADAP job.

Step by Step Process (Simplified)

1. Entry Survey
2. Account Setup & Validation
 - a. Create throwaway email
 - b. Create accounts on Social Media
 - c. Upload Account Validation Screenshots
3. Task #1
 - a. Scrolling Session 1 (with specified activities) : 50 videos per app
 - i. Upload Screen Recording Session 1 (per app)
 - ii. ADAP Data Entry (for each video in Session 1)
4. Task #1b
 - a. Watch and Upload Screen Recordings (No ADAP Data Entry)
5. Task #2
 - a. Scrolling Session (1) with specified activities
 - i. ADAP Data Entry (one entry for each video watched and one for the session)
 - ii. Upload Screen Recording Session 1 (per app)
6. Task #3
 - a. Scrolling Session with specified activity #1
 - i. ADAP Data Entry
 - ii. Upload Screen Recording Session (per app)
 - b. Scrolling Session with specified activity #2
 - i. ADAP Data Entry
 - ii. Upload Screen Recording Session (per app)
7. Exit Survey

Step 1. Entry Survey

- a. Contributors will complete an entry survey to gauge initial information on app usage and personal preference when watching short form videos
- b. In this survey, please list and rank your preferred interests. List 5 interest pairs (10 interests total), each consisting of one broad interest and one related niche interest. Then rank the 5 pairs from most important (Rank 1) to least important (Rank 5) based on how much you would want to see this type of content in your feed. All 5 pairs should be things you genuinely like and want to see. Rank 5 is your least prioritized interest, not something you dislike. These should reflect things that you are currently interested in. Aim for a diverse set of topics that correspond with the following requirements:

- i. Include a mix of (5) broad, high level interests (e.g., sports, music) and (5) specific niche interests (e.g., Fashion [broad] → Louis Vuitton bags [niche], Art [broad] → street photography [niche])
- ii. In the group of ten interests, each niche interest should be related to a respective broad interest [ex: "Art" (Broad) and "Pencil Drawing" (Niche)] to create a pair
- iii. Each of the 5 broad interests must be completely different from each other - do not repeat or overlap categories. Given that the broad interests are different, each of the 5 niche interests should also be different as well.
 1. Acceptable: - (#1) Fitness → Yoga, (#2) Automobiles → Electric Vehicles
 2. Not Acceptable: (#1) Fitness → Yoga, (#2) Fitness → Pilates
- iv. For each interest, also briefly define and make a personal note on what specific content would qualify as matching the interests you've listed
- v. Raters should keep a note of and track these interests. Certain questions will ask you to refer back to the list in your responses.

Quick guide on how to think about different types of interests with examples.

Broad interests are general content categories that cover a wide variety of subjects and topics. Niche interests are specialized subsets within the general content categories that target very specific subjects and topics. **Please only use this set of examples as a guide.**

Broad Interest	Niche Interest
Beauty	Makeup Tutorial
Fitness	Yoga Routines
Fashion	Designer Try-On Haul
Gaming	Best RPGs of 2025
Travel	Best Places to Eat in Paris
Music	80s Rock Bands
Technology	Budget Home Office Setup
Cooking	At Home Cajun Meals
Art	Photography Time-Lapses
Finance	Retirement Accounts
Education	Med School Application Tips
Animals	Cat Reactions
Lifestyle	Day in the Life Vlog
Books	New York Times Best Sellers
Sports	UFC

How to answer interest matching questions for broad vs. niche interests

When answering whether a video matches your stated interests in ADAP, consider broad and niche interests separately:

- A video about NFL highlights for a rater who listed Sports (broad) → UFC (niche) matches the broad interest only (Sports). Select "Sports" in the interest matching question. For the content description question, select "Broad content related to my interests."
- A video about a UFC fight matches both the broad and niche interest (Sports and UFC). Select both "Sports" and "UFC" in the interest matching question. For the content description question, select "Niche content from my interests" or "A mix of broad and niche elements."
- A video about tennis for the same rater also matches the broad interest only (Sports). Select "Sports." The niche interest (UFC) is specific to MMA/fighting, so tennis does not qualify as a niche match.

The key distinction: your broad interest captures the general category. Your niche interest captures a specific subset. A video can match the broad without matching the niche, but a video that matches the niche will almost always also match the broad.

Quick guide on how to think about ranking your interests

After listing your 5 interest pairs, rank them from 1 (most important) to 5 (least important). Your ranking should reflect how much you personally care about seeing this type of content in your feed.

Ask yourself: "If I could only see content from one of my interest categories, which would I choose first?" That is your Rank 1. Repeat for the remaining four. **Important:** Every interest you list should be something you want to see. Your Rank 5 interest is still something you enjoy, just less important to you than Ranks 1-4.

Please only use this set of examples as a guide.

Rank	Broad Interest	Niche Interest	What Counts As a Match
1	Sports	UFC	Videos showing UFC fights, fighter analysis, weigh-ins, or MMA training clips
2	Cooking	At Home Cajun Meals	Recipes or cooking demos for Cajun dishes like gumbo or jambalaya made at home
3	Technology	Budget Home Office Setup	Reviews of affordable desks, monitors, or chairs; home office tours under \$500
4	Travel	Best places to eat in Paris	Restaurant reviews, food tours, or dining recommendations specifically in Paris
5	Fitness	Yoga Routines	Videos demonstrating yoga flows, guided sessions, or pose tutorials

Step 2. Set Up Throwaway Account and Upload Account Validation Screenshots

A. Create a throwaway email to use for this project.

Reminders on email address creation:

- **DO NOT use old email from previous project versions.** A brand-new email and social media accounts should be used for this new project version.
- ONLY use this email for the project, NOT for personal use for the duration of the study.
- DO NOT include your exact birthday, etc. in the email address.
- DO NOT include the words Appen, TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Thyme, "throwaway", "project", or anything else related to the project in the email address.
- **Use your real first and last name, in the email address and Social Media accounts** to help avoid account banishment.
- Be sure to add a recovery/verification method to your email account in the creation steps to avoid email account banishment.
- **The best practice is to create one unique throwaway email prefix per app to avoid account banishment, a total of 3 throwaway emails.**
- You may use any email address provider you prefer (e.g., Gmail, Outlook, Proton Mail, Yahoo, etc.)
 - a. **Good Examples (DO NOT USE THESE EXAMPLES):**
 - i. johnsmith123@gmail.com
 - ii. richardjhons00@outlook.com
 - iii. ashleythompson5678@protonmail.com
 - b. **Bad Examples (DO NOT USE THESE EXAMPLES):**
 - i. jhosephineappen784@hotmail.com
 - ii. throwawayemail@yahoo.com
 - iii. thymejonathan845@protonmail.com
- Using those throwaway emails, create brand new social media accounts on Instagram, TikTok, and Facebook.

B. Create accounts on Facebook, Instagram and TikTok

Reminders on social media accounts creation:

- Download each app from the App Store (iOS) or Google Play Store (Android) on your phone; do not use the browser to access these sites. Doing so may result in your dataset being rejected.
- Wait at least 30 minutes after creating your throwaway email to start creating your social media account to avoid instant social media account banishments.
- Use the exact same first and last name created on each one of the 3 throwaway emails to match the first and last name of each social media account.
- The best practice is to create your username using an exact combination of your first and last name and numbers then use that as the prefix to create your throwaway email account. Example:
 - a. App1 Throwaway Email → johnsmith123@gmail.com
 - i. App1 First Name: John
 - ii. App1 Last Name: Smith
 - iii. App1 Username: johnsmith123
 - b. App2 Throwaway Email → johnsmith789@gmail.com
 - i. App2 First Name: John
 - ii. App2 Last Name: Smith

- iii. App2 Username: johnsmith789
- c. App3 Throwaway Email → johnsmith456@gmail.com
 - i. App3 First Name: John
 - ii. App3 Last Name: Smith
 - iii. App3 Username: johnsmith456

Always double-check the Email, Username, and First and Last name spelling before submitting the data on ADAP to avoid errors, as this information will be used to check the social media accounts activity to validate the contributor's data set.

- Aim to have the same format of throwaway email for all three apps to start data collection
- **DO NOT upload a profile picture to your social media accounts.**
- When prompted to provide demographic info on your throwaway account, please input your actual gender and birth year (you can provide any month and day for the birthdate section on the app).
- Ensure that the month/date entered does not result in an age under 18 years old. If you turned 18 years old THIS CALENDAR YEAR, ensure the day/month you enter is before the day/month you make your account).
- DO NOT provide any other demographic information.
- **DO NOT input any interests on the app.**
- **DO NOT make your account private.** Your account should be public to the quality team to check its details.



- **DO NOT link your Instagram Account to Facebook Account.** (please see [How to Avoid Linking Instagram account to Facebook Account and Vice Versa](#))
- Accept the terms of service for creating new accounts on each app.
- **Reminders on account usage:** These accounts should be used only for the tasks stated in the contributor exercise for the full duration of the project.

How to Avoid Linking Instagram account to Facebook Account and Vice Versa

Instagram:

1. Click on "Create new account".
2. Select "Sign up with email".
3. Click Skip on the "Get Facebook suggestions" window.
4. Click Skip when you see "Follow friends".

Facebook:

1. After clicking "Create new account", if prompted with "Creating account with Instagram" DO NOT click on "Continue with Instagram". Click on "Creating account manually".
2. Click "Get started". DO NOT click "I already have an account".
3. When asked, click "EMAIL", insert your Throwingaway Mail.
4. Click "Next".
5. When prompted with "Turn on contact uploading to find friends faster" click "Not now". DO NOT click "Turn on".



C. Upload Account Validation Screenshots

The account validation screenshots should be uploaded to a dedicated Google Drive folder. The folder link will be shared by the project team.

1. Once **you are done setting up your accounts**, capture screenshots of account validation per app and upload in the same assigned Google Drive folder. Refer to detailed steps in [How To Get Account Validation Screenshots](#).
 - a. Use below file name template
 - i **Account Verification:** (Account_App_#)
 - ii **Username Verification:** (Username_App)

("#" means the order number of screenshots, e.g., Account_FB_1, Account_FB_2....)
2. Ensure that you do not upload these to your personal Google Drive

How To Get Account Validation Screenshots

Upload the screenshots of the following instructions on the Google Drive Folder.

Account Verification Steps

1. **On Facebook**
 - a. Open the FB App.
 - b. Tap the 3 lines in the top-right of FB to go to the Menu screen.
 - c. Tap the cog icon in the top-right to go to Settings & Privacy.
 - d. On the Settings & Privacy page, tap "See more in Accounts Center."
 - e. Under the Account Settings section, tap "Your information and permissions."
 - f. Tap "Access your information."

- g. Tap Privacy Center.
 - h. Scroll down to "View and manage the info we've collected about you". If not found, scroll down and click on "View all topics" to reveal it.
 - i. Tap "Get Started."
 - j. Tap Review Your Information.
 - k. Select Facebook.
 - l. Select your account and enter your credentials if prompted to do so.
 - m. Tap Personal Information.
 - n. Screenshot your account creation data under the heading "Profile Information."
 - o. Click on "Your Contact Information".
 - p. Screenshot your Contact Info, showing the throwaway email address used.
 - q. Upload BOTH screenshots from steps m and n to your assigned Google Drive Folder
- 2. On Instagram**
- a. Click your profile photo in the app
 - b. Click the hamburger icon (three horizontal lines) in the top right corner of your screen
 - c. Click "Your activity"
 - d. Scroll down to "Account History"
 - e. Screenshot your Email and Account Created date
 - f. Upload screenshots from step e to your assigned Google Drive Folder.
- 3. On TikTok**
- a. Click your profile photo in the app
 - b. Click the hamburger icon (three horizontal lines) in the top right corner of your screen
 - c. Click "Settings and Privacy"
 - d. Click "Activity Center"
 - e. Click "Account History" and take a screenshot
 - f. Upload screenshots from step e to your assigned Google Drive Folder.

Username Verification Steps

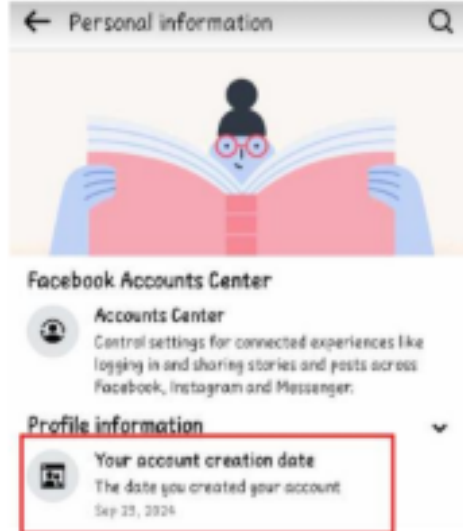
- 1. On Facebook**
 - a. Go to account center
 - b. Click "Profiles"
 - c. Click your app profile
 - d. Click "Username"
 - e. Screenshot the username
 - f. Upload screenshot from step e to your assigned Google Drive Folder.
- 2. On Instagram**
 - a. Go to account center
 - b. Click "Profiles"
 - c. Click your app profile
 - d. Click "Username"
 - e. Screenshot the username
 - f. Upload screenshot from step e to your assigned Google Drive Folder.
- 3. On TikTok**
 - a. Click your profile photo in the app
 - b. Screenshot your profile
 - c. Upload screenshot from step b to your assigned Google Drive Folder.

Sample Screenshots for Account Validation

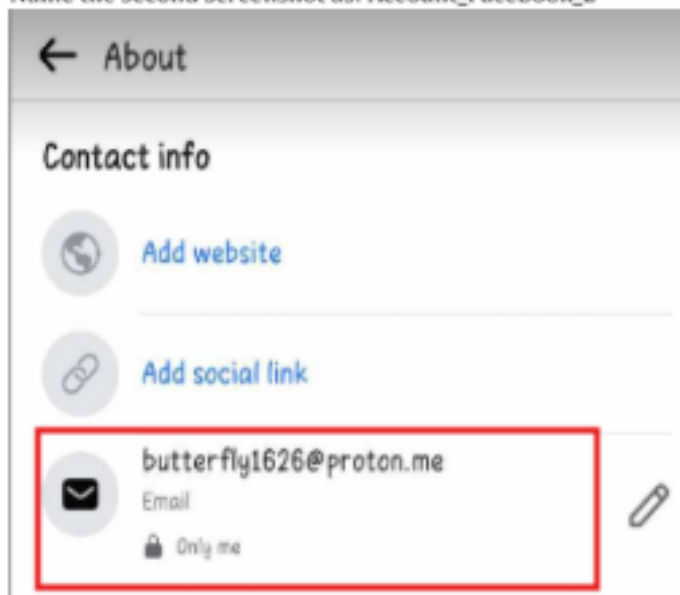
Account Verification

Facebook – 2 screenshots in total, showing account creation date (1) and throwaway email (2).

- i. Name the first screenshot as: Account_FB_1



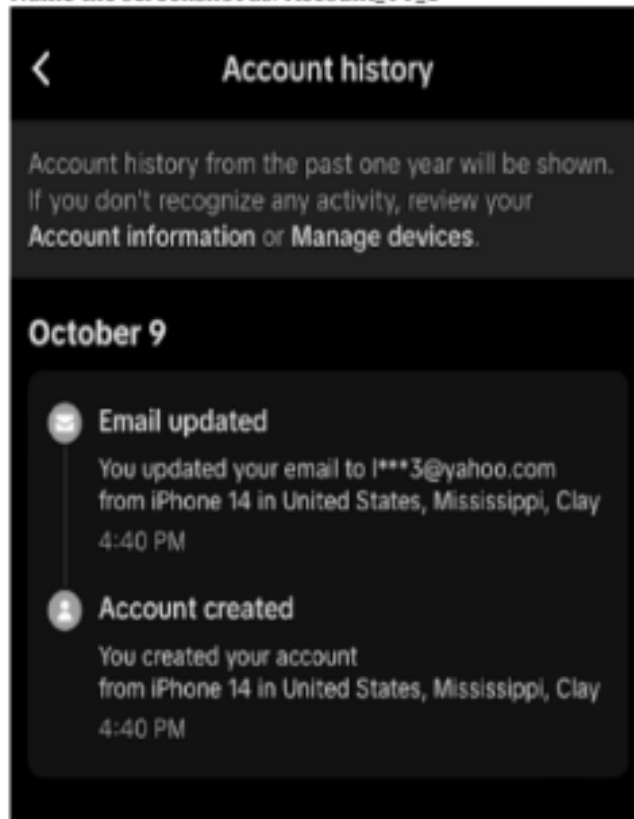
- ii. Name the second screenshot as: Account_Facebook_2



- b. Instagram - 1 screenshot in total, showing account creation date and throwaway email.

- i. Name the screenshot as: Account_IG_1

- c. TikTok - 1 screenshot in total, showing account creation date and throwaway email.
- i. Name the screenshot as: Account_TT_1



Account Verification Example:

 Account_FB_1.PNG 

 Account_FB_2.PNG 

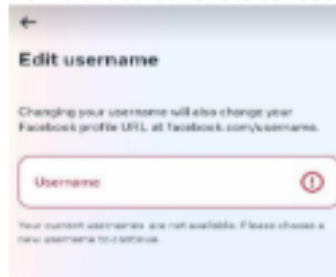
 Account_IG_1.PNG 

 Account_TT_1.PNG 

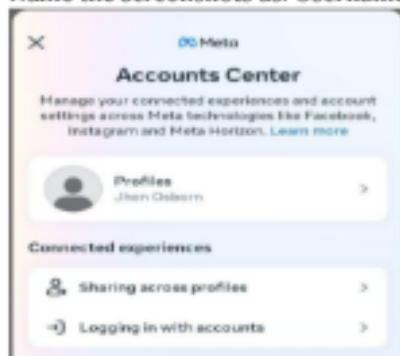
Username Verification

- a. Facebook – Should show the username.
If it shows that you are unable to create their username, it should be okay. However, an additional screenshot is required.

- i. Screenshot with the username error message.
Name the screenshots as: Username_Facebook_1



- ii. Screenshot showing Meta Account Center with first and last name at the top.
Name the screenshots as: Username_Facebook_2

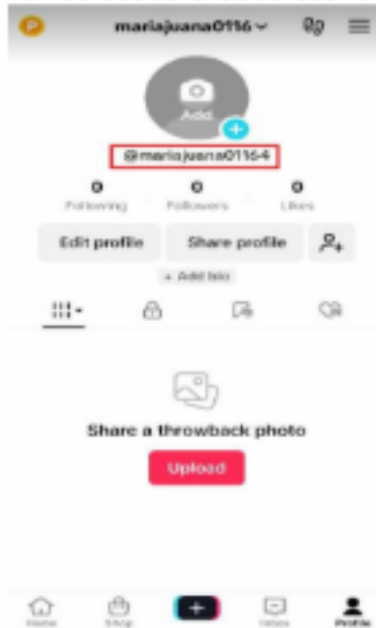


- b. Instagram- Should show the username.
i. Name the screenshots as: Username_Instagram



- c. TikTok - Should show the username.

- i. Name the screenshots as: Username_TikTok



Username screenshots example:

	Username_FB_1.PNG	
	Username_FB_2.PNG	
	Username_IG.PNG	
	Username_TT.PNG	

Step 3a: Early Stage - Task #1

For this phase, contributors will watch 1 session consisting of 50 videos each for each app (i.e. 50 videos each session x 1 sessions x 3 apps), while screen recording on each of the three apps for a total of 150 videos (50 videos per app).

For each app: Use the app as you normally would - watching, liking and or re-watching any videos that you find engaging/ interested in personally and [selecting "Not Interested"](#) for any videos you are not interested in. **NOTE: it is MANDATORY to select 'Not Interested' before switching to the next video in this task if you do not "Like" a video.**

Switching apps is also mandatory. Each app should have one scrolling session attached to it for this task. Please follow the assigned app sequence found in your Onboarding / Welcome to the Project email. **Example:** Contributor A has an assigned app sequence of TT->IG->FB. They first watch 50 videos on TikTok then continue to watch 50 videos on Instagram and finally 50 videos on Facebook. **The best practice is to pin and save your onboarding email for future reference.**

Scrolling Session Reminders

1. This session should have a **maximum** of 50 videos which should be at a natural pace.
 - a. Aim for whatever viewing cadence is good for you. Contributors should operate within the storage limitations of their device.
 - Please note that screen recordings can take up a significant amount of storage space. Please ensure that you have adequate (GB's worth) of free storage space before screen recording.
 - b. You don't have to watch a video in its entirety (unless you choose to do so) for it to count for data collection. If a video is not interesting initially, feel free to select 'Not Interested' and move on to the next video directly. **At minimum, watch enough of the video to make a judgement on whether or not it is interesting to you before selecting 'Not Interested' and moving to the next video.**
 - c. Keep a count of how many videos you've watched so that you don't pass 50 videos. App submissions under 50 videos will not be accepted.
 - d. **DO NOT count sponsored content, advertisement, or live videos as part of the 50 videos.**
2. DO NOT watch the same video more than 3 times.
 - a. Additional Info:
 - If you find a video interesting and want to keep watching, up to 2 full re-watches of the same video are acceptable and this still counts as 1 video for data collection purposes.
 - Note on counting loops (rewatches): If you watch a video completely on the 1st run and then watch it for half the duration on the 2nd run, then that counts as (1) loop. If you watch the video in its entirety twice then this is considered as (2) loops. It is only counted as a loop if the video is watched in its entirety.
3. DO NOT interact (**comment, share, see description, follow profiles, etc.**) with any other parts of the app or user experience unless explicitly instructed to do so.
4. Be careful while scrolling to avoid accidentally following accounts, as the Reels interface has a follow button on the screen that can be mistakenly clicked while scrolling through the videos. **If you accidentally follow an account immediately, unfollow them.** Do not comment on the videos.
5. Go to this section for detailed instructions on [how to access and select 'Not Interested'](#) on each app

*Once your account has been created, start screen recording your scrolling session **before** opening each app (please see [How to Screen Record](#) below for additional information).*

Session 1

1. Once the countdown starts, take note of what time it is when you start your recording session, as this will be used for subsequent data entry later.
2. Once your scrolling session ends and you stop recording, take note of what time you ended your recording session for later data entry.
3. Once the session is over, stop recording, close the app, **save your screen recording video and ensure to transfer the screen recording file to your computer** using the file name format: **Task1A_App** (ex: Task1A_FB, Task 1A_IG, Task1A_TT)
4. Move on to the [ADAP Data Entry](#) step. There, you will watch your recording again and use the pause feature to answer questions about each video watched in the session.
5. Note: Answer all video and session level questions for Session 1 on a particular app before moving on to the next app in the sequence. Do not perform data entry for multiple apps at once.
6. Repeat the instructions in the next app of your assigned sequence until you have scrolled/submitted through 50 total videos on each app.
7. Keep a count of how many videos you've watched so that you don't pass 50 videos. App submissions under 50 videos will not be accepted.